

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2♠

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K 7 3
 ♥ Q J 9 8 6 5
 ♦ Q 8 6 2
 ♣ -

♠ 10 8 5

♥ A K 7

♦ A 7 3

♣ A Q 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 9 4 2

♥ 10 3

♦ 10 9

♣ J 10 9 8 4

♠ A Q 6

♥ 4 2

♦ K J 5 4

♣ K 7 3 2

West	North	East	South
2♥	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North

the first trick so you win the ♥A. Then you play the ♣A . . . and West discards a ♦!

Don't be sad that the ♣s didn't split, your contract is now guaranteed! Well, guaranteed as long as West has only a 6-card ♥ suit.

Play your ♥K, and when East follows suit play your ♥7. West wins this trick and he can also win 3 more ♥ tricks. But when he runs out of ♥s he will be forced to play a ♠ or a ♦ because he doesn't have any ♣s. Either one will give you your ninth trick.

If the ♣s had split 4-1 you wouldn't know it until you played a second ♣.

But it wouldn't matter, you would still play the same way. As long as you can strip West of any ♣s you can make the throw-in.

Over an opponent's Weak 2-bid a 2NT overcall is used to show basically the same as a 1NT opening bid, but promising stopper(s) in their suit.

Partner bids 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥10. As expected, East leads his partner's ♥ suit.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 8

You need only one more winner; the best chance will be a 3-2 split in ♣s. But if that doesn't happen you might have to try the finesse in either ♠s or ♦s. The problem is that both finesses go into the West hand. Because of that fact there is no reason to hold up on

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 8 6 2
♥ 10 8 7 4
♦ Q 6 5 3
♣ 7

♠ A 5

♥ Q J 6

♦ K J 9 2

♣ 10 9 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 9 4

♥ A 5 3

♦ A 8

♣ A 8 6 3

♠ K 7 3

♥ K 9 2

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K Q J 4

West

North

East

South

2♣

Pass

2♠

1NT

Pass

All Pass

2♠ by East

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 8

That is a lot of losers. But it makes the plan that much easier. You will try to make as many of dummy's small trumps as you can, and you will do that by ruffing ♣s.

Win the ♣A and ruff a ♣ in dummy. Return to your hand with the ♦A and ruff another ♣. Back to your hand with the ♥A and ruff another ♣.

You have taken 6 tricks already and cannot be prevented from winning two more trumps.

Making those small trumps by ruffing was a pretty obvious play.

Lucky for you the defenders didn't see the advantage of playing three rounds of trumps right off the bat.

It would be tough for South to come up with a ♠ lead from ♠ K 7 3, but it would have been great defense.

You have a bad hand. Bad, bad, bad hand. But you think playing in ♠s, ♥s or ♦s would be better than playing 1NT. Can you get partner to bid one of those suits? Sure, you just say 2♣. Partner says 2♠. Your call.

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Your dream just came true. So pass and it won't turn into a nightmare.

The contract would be 2♠ played by West.

East plays 2♠. South leads the ♣K.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 2

♥ 9

♦ K 9 7 4

♣ K Q J 9 2

♠ K 6 3

♥ A K J 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 7 6 4



♠ 10 9 5 4

♥ 10 7 5 3

♦ J 10 3

♣ 8 5

♠ A J 7

♥ Q 8 6 4

♦ A Q 6

♣ A 10 3

Holding a 4-card ♥ suit some bidders would use Stayman. However, when you have 4-3-3-3 distribution there is little chance of ruffing so others prefer not to use Stayman. You take the latter view and bid 3NT with your 11 points.

The contract would be 3NT played by North.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♣K and East follows with the ♣5.

Do you hold up? If so, how many times?

West	North	East	South
			1NT

Pass	3NT		
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All Pass

3NT by South

so the question of disrupting opponent's communications doesn't arise - East is not going to get the lead.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 4 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 8

Your ninth trick will be either the ♠J or the ♦Q. In both cases the finesse would be into the West hand

Nonetheless it is a good idea to hold up - **but only once**.

West then plays the ♣Q which you win as East follows. Next you run four ♥ tricks, ending in dummy. You play dummy's ♠K, your sixth trick so far. It is crunch time. Do you now finesse for the ♦K or the ♠Q?

The answer is NO, you do not take either finesse. Instead you play a ♣, hoping West must take the trick. And he does. West then cashes two more ♣ tricks but then he is out of ♣s. Since he is also out of ♥s he is going to have to play either a ♠ or a ♦, either one of which will make you very happy!

The reason for holding up on the first ♣ but taking the second was to keep your options open for the endplay.

If East had not followed to the second ♣ you might not have been able to use the endplay. Instead you would have run the ♥s, and if West did not discard a ♣, you would have to guess as to which finesse to try. With the cards as shown neither would have worked.